

COINPICKS · RESEARCH & EDUCATION

Iran War Risk Pillar Report

Middle East Conflict Risk — Researched, Scored, and Personally Committed

*Originally written June 19, 2026; scores committed by me June 19, 2026. Fully re-researched & updated on July 8, 2026 against live primary sources — the re-rated scores in this version are **DRAFT**, awaiting my stamp.*

COINPICKS PILLAR REPORT · WEIGHT: 25% OF MY THESIS

Written June 19, 2026 · Updated & Re-verified July 8, 2026 · Not Financial Advice

The Scores — June Committed vs. July 8 Draft

June column committed by me June 19, 2026 · Draft column re-rated July 8, 2026 — awaiting my stamp

WINDOW	MY JUNE P	DRAFT P (JUL 8)	QUALITY	IMPACT	SIGNAL	MY CALL
1 month	50	40	0.60	7	-0.8	Mild Bear — active shoot-back loop
3 months	55	47	0.65	7	-0.3	Neutral
6 months	62	55	0.70	7	+0.5	Neutral (borderline; exact signal 0.49)
1 year	75	70	0.65	7	+1.8	Bull (dip-buy, delayed)
3 years	85	83	0.55	7	+2.5	Bull

Draft P: 40 / 47 / 55 / 70 / 83 · **My Weight:** 25% · **My Impact:** 7 · **Formula:** Signal = $((P - 50) \div 50) \times \text{Quality} \times \text{Impact}$. Draft scores re-rated July 8, 2026 from the June baseline (50 / 55 / 62 / 75 / 85) — awaiting my stamp.

THE THREE INPUTS, IN PLAIN ENGLISH

P — the odds this is *good for crypto* by then. Near-term now *below* a coin flip: Trump declared the ceasefire "over" on July 8 and both sides are actively trading strikes, with Hormuz effectively closed to commercial shipping. Long-term still high — these same two sides walked back from the brink twice this year (April 8, June 8), and war shocks have historically faded.

Quality — how trustworthy the evidence is. The near-term windows carry live fog-of-war (an exchange still in motion as of July 8); the multi-year read still leans on a thin sample, so Quality tops at 0.70 and falls to 0.55. Every source is on the last page — click and judge for yourself.

Impact — 7 out of 10, unchanged. Even US strikes on 80+ targets inside Iran plus a "ceasefire over" headline moved BTC only ~2–3% on July 8. A war shock hits crypto hard for days — but it stays one input among many.

The Claim

The thesis, and where I differ from the consensus — updated July 8, 2026

The crowd: "the ceasefire is over" — Trump said it himself on July 8. Missiles into tankers, the Strait of Hormuz declared closed, US strikes on 80+ targets inside Iran, IRGC drones at US bases in Bahrain and Kuwait. The loud story is pure risk-off: stay out until it's over.

Me: near-term I'm with the bears for once — 40% good-for-crypto at 1 month, because an active shoot-back loop with re-sanctioned oil is no place to be a hero. But the arc holds: 83% over three years. The dip is still a buy — it just isn't fully formed yet.

My edge: the market itself is telling you how desensitized it is — the July 8 escalation bought a ~2–3% BTC dip to ~\$61.7k, not a crash. The risk isn't the headlines the crowd fears; it's the quiet paths — a US-casualty event, a formal MoU death by ~Aug 16, a confirmed full Hormuz closure. I watch those, not the noise.

The Facts

As of July 8, 2026 — hard numbers only, sources on the last page. ★ = new since June 19

- ★ **Tanker attacks, night of July 6–7:** the IRGC fired ≥ 2 missiles at commercial ships in/near the Strait of Hormuz. Two merchant vessels hit that night: Qatari LNG carrier **Al Rekayyat** (struck ~8nm off Limah, Oman — engine-room fire, crew abandoned ship) and Saudi crude tanker **Wedyan** (damaged); a third vessel was hit within 24 hours — **three hit in total** — and four more tankers turned back rather than transit. Tehran did not officially claim responsibility.
- ★ **This was the second round in ten days.** On **June 27** an Iranian one-way attack drone hit the tanker **M/T Kiku** (Panama-flagged, 2M+ bbl of crude); the US struck targets in Iran the same day (CENTCOM release), and the IRGC hit US sites in **Kuwait and Bahrain on June 28**. The ceasefire has now cracked at least **three times** since April (June 7–8, June 27–28, July 6–8).
- ★ **US response, late July 7 → July 8:** CENTCOM struck **80+ Iranian targets** early July 8 (hours after the ship attacks) — air defenses, coastal radar, C2, anti-ship missile sites, 60+ IRGC small boats; explosions on Qeshm Island and at Sirik. CENTCOM called it roughly **8x larger than the June 27 round**. Later July 8 the IRGC claimed attacks on **85 US military sites in Bahrain and Kuwait** — its second strike on Gulf bases in ~10 days (missiles/drones; Bahrain sirens 3x; no casualties reported) — and vowed to "retaliate in a harsher way."
- ★ **Ceasefire declared over:** at the NATO summit in Ankara on **July 8**, Trump: "I think it's over... I'll let our wonderful negotiators keep talking if they want, but I don't see it." Additional US strikes were underway Wednesday night.
- ★ **Hormuz squeeze:** Iran declared the strait shut back on **~June 22**; traffic had been recovering (a widened route opened June 27) until the July 6–8 attacks left it **effectively closed to commercial shipping as of July 8** (US says some vessels still transiting). Unofficial tracker data (straits.live): throughput ~39–41% of pre-crisis as of **July 5 — pre-attack** — with VLCC war-risk premiums ~8x normal. Insurance Journal (July 8): war-risk rates **~3% of hull value**, up from 2% a week earlier ("probably at 5% at the least" per one underwriter), with underwriters advising owners to **pause Hormuz voyages**; trade press puts Hormuz-transit VLCC fixtures at ~\$440–470K/day.
- ★ **Oil re-sanctioned:** the US Treasury revoked the MoU waiver allowing Iranian oil sales on **July 7** — wind-down completes by **July 17**.
- **Oil price:** Brent settled +3% at **\$74.16** July 7, then +5.2% at **\$78.02** July 8 (WTI +4.4%, \$73.52) — ~+9% in two sessions, yet still *below* the ~\$80 June 19 baseline (oil had faded to ~\$72 during the de-escalation).
- **Diplomacy — resumed, then stalled:** after the June 19 Switzerland cancellation, talks restarted (a "Lake Lucerne Summit," then indirect technical talks in **Doha, June 30–July 2**; Vance July 1: "going well"; concluded July 2 with "positive progress" claimed but no breakthrough). Doha did produce two concrete outcomes: agreement to release the first **\$3B tranche** of ~\$6B in Qatar-held frozen Iranian funds, and an MoU-violations reporting channel. Sticking points: Hormuz transit fees (Iran July 4: will "definitely" charge; US rejects) and the rest of the frozen funds. The sides agreed in principle to reconvene after the Khamenei funeral processions (July 4–9) — the July 8 US strikes reportedly broke a promised funeral-period pause — but as of July 8 **no date is set**; Iran's FM says talks "will not commence if threats continue"; Tehran has **not** formally declared the MoU dead. The 60-day window runs to **~Aug 16**.
- **Israel is out of this round:** no direct Israel–Iran exchange since June 7–8, and Israel was not a participant in the July 7–8 strikes (Netanyahu visited Haifa naval base July 7, "eye to eye" with Trump). Israel–Hezbollah simmers on — Rubio announced an Israel–Lebanon "framework deal" June 26 — but it is not the July driver.
- **Crypto now:** BTC slipped from **\$62,657** in Asia hours July 8 toward **~\$62K** (–1.7 to –2.5% by outlet; some trackers print high-\$61Ks), selloff explicitly attributed to the "ceasefire over" remarks and the strikes. Context that matters: BTC had *already* printed ~\$61.7K on **July 6 — a 21-month low — before this escalation**, so the war headlines pushed price only back toward a level it had just visited. **~\$450M** total liquidations (~\$350M in altcoins); SOL wiped out its July rally.

- **The odds:** Polymarket "US invades Iran before 2027" jumped **11.5% → 14.5%** on the strikes (independently reported); "Iran withdraws from MoU talks by Aug 15" at **26%** and "US–Iran final nuclear deal by Dec 31" at **35.5%** (read directly off Polymarket July 8 — live snapshots, they move).
- **The baseline (still true, still load-bearing):** June 2025 "12-Day War" — BTC dipped to a **~\$98,225 intraday low (June 22, 2025)**, reclaimed \$107k+ by June 25, a fast V. The far larger 2026 regime-change war (**Feb 28 → Apr 8, 2026**; Khamenei killed Feb 28, confirmed by Iran March 1) still didn't crater crypto on Iran-specific grounds.

The Prize

Illustrative only — not price targets, not advice

The upside is still the **"buy-the-invasion" rebound**. Anchors: Russia–Ukraine (Feb 24, 2022) — BTC fell ~8% to a **~\$34,300 intraday low**, posted a +14.5% up-day on Feb 28, ended **~+25–29% above the low within a week** (~+38% by late March). June 2025 rhymed: ~\$98k dip, fully recovered within a week.

The test is live right now. July 8's dip was only ~2–3% to ~\$61.7k — a desensitized market means shallower dips and smaller Vs. The bigger prize is the settlement scenario: a signed deal plus the reported ~\$300B reconstruction fund re-pricing the whole region after oil re-sanctioning. Still a thin sample; the Prize doesn't feed the math — it tells you what the lean is worth acting on.

The Other Side

The strongest honest case this is wrong

- **BTC is a risk asset here, not a safe haven — and the oil-shock path now has numbers.** Goldman's April scenario: Brent averages **>\$100 in 2026** if Hormuz stays largely shut another month (\$120 Q3 / \$115 Q4); JPMorgan: **\$120–130** if disruption persists through Q3, **~\$150** in a full-closure worst case. That is an inflation shock — crypto falls *with* equities, the opposite of the dip-buy.
- **It keeps breaking.** The ceasefire has now cracked at least three times since April — June 7–8, June 27–28, and July 6–8's "it's over." The rounds are getting closer together and bigger. Each one, "time heals" gets directly contradicted.
- **The shallow dip may be complacency, not resilience.** Markets are pricing a contained flare-up (BTC –2–3%, Brent \$78 — below the June baseline). That pricing is fragile to a US-casualty event, a formal MoU withdrawal, or a confirmed full closure — any one repricing gaps down, not drifts.
- **Thin sample, still.** The bullish long-term read rests on ~2 dip-and-recover events, both in a bull regime — geopolitical shocks don't always V-recover.

The Triggers

Dated events ahead — some prove the claim right, some prove it wrong. Reset July 8, 2026

DATE	EVENT	MEANS
July 17, 2026	Iranian oil-sale waiver wind-down completes (Treasury revoked July 7)	Sanctions bite — Tehran's pressure to escalate or deal rises
By ~Aug 16, 2026	Formal MoU withdrawal or 60-day window expires unsigned (Polymarket: 26% withdrawal by Aug 15)	Diplomacy dead — re-rate 1/3/6-month down
Any time	Confirmed full Hormuz closure / Brent through \$90	Oil shock confirmed — re-rate near-term down hard
Any time	US-casualty event (Bahrain/Kuwait bases, Gulf shipping)	Escalation spiral — re-rate down hard
Any time	Doha / Lake Lucerne talks resume	Off-ramp reopens — partial re-rate up
By Dec 31, 2026	Final US–Iran nuclear deal signed (Polymarket: 35.5%)	De-escalation confirmed — re-rate up across windows

The flip line: a US invasion / regime-change round two, or a sustained *full* Hormuz closure with Brent north of \$100 = treat the dip-buy thesis as broken. June's flip line was "wider war + Hormuz oil shock" — as of July 8 we are halfway there. A contained shoot-back loop that burns out keeps the long-term Bull.

My Decision

ⓘ **UPDATED DRAFT — JULY 8, 2026 · AWAITING MY STAMP**

Draft P: 40 / 47 / 55 / 70 / 83 · My Weight: 25% · My Impact: 7

The June committed scores (**50 / 55 / 62 / 75 / 85**, committed June 19, 2026) remain the last human-stamped values — the draft above re-rates every window down off the broken ceasefire, the live shoot-back loop, and the impaired MoU, while keeping the long arc intact.

Still a **dip-watching pillar, not a panic-selling one** — but for the first time the 1-month lean is Bear. The market's 2–3% shrug at 80+ strikes says desensitized; the accident paths into ~Aug 16 say don't lean on it.

Override any P and re-stamp — the master blend recomputes.

What Changed Since Last Check

Re-researched July 8, 2026 (previous check June 19, 2026)

- **Trigger FIRED — renewed direct strikes (twice):** the June 27–28 round (tanker M/T Kiku hit; US strikes; IRGC hit Kuwait/Bahrain) and the ~8×-larger July 6–8 round (three tankers hit; 80+ targets struck; IRGC hit Gulf bases again). BTC dipped only ~2% — the buy-the-dip test is live now.
- **Trigger FIRED (substantially) — Hormuz:** the strait (declared shut by Iran since ~June 22) is effectively closed to commercial shipping after the July 6–8 attacks; war-risk rates ~3% of hull value and rising (Insurance Journal), underwriters advising pauses; Brent +8–9% in two sessions to \$78. Not a total physical closure — some vessels still transiting.

- **Trigger FIRED (ceasefire leg) — collapse:** Trump declared the ceasefire "over" July 8 and hostilities resumed; the MoU is impaired but neither side has formally withdrawn.
- **Trigger NOT fired — nuclear deal:** the 60-day window (to ~Aug 16) is nominally alive but badly impaired — Doha ended July 2 with partial outcomes (\$3B tranche agreed, violations channel) but no breakthrough; reconvening after the Khamenei funerals was agreed in principle, no date set.
- **Material new facts:** the previously-unlogged June 27–28 escalation round (M/T Kiku, US strikes, IRGC on Kuwait/Bahrain); IRGC missile attacks on three commercial tankers July 6–8; US Treasury revoked the Iranian oil waiver July 7 (wind-down by July 17); ~\$450M crypto liquidations July 8; Polymarket invasion-before-2027 odds 11.5% → 14.5%.
- **Score re-rates (June committed → July 8 draft):** 1mo 50→40 · 3mo 55→47 · 6mo 62→55 · 1yr 75→70 · 3yr 85→83 — draft only, awaiting my stamp.

Sources

Retrieved & graded July 8, 2026 — click and judge the quality yourself. Official statements are quoted inside the wire reporting below; then prices, then betting markets (sentiment only).

- **The escalation (official statements via wire reporting):** NPR — Hormuz tanker attacks (July 7) · CNN — Iran tanker attack (July 7) · CBS live — Treasury waiver revocation, CENTCOM 80+ targets, IRGC 85-site claim · NBC — new US strikes (July 8) · Times of Israel liveblog — strike detail, Netanyahu at Haifa (July 8) · Al Jazeera — Trump "ceasefire over" quotes (July 8) · Bloomberg — ceasefire over (July 8) · Wikipedia — 2026 Hormuz crisis timeline (secondhand compilation, used for sequencing only).
- **Diplomacy:** Al Jazeera — attacks vs the talks (July 7) · Al Jazeera — Doha outcomes (July 2) · CNN live — Vance "going well" (July 1).
- **The prices:** CNBC — Brent \$74.16 (July 7) · CNBC — Brent \$78.02 / WTI \$73.52 (July 8) · straits.live — Hormuz throughput tracker (34 transits July 5) · Insurance Journal — war-risk rates ~3% of hull value, pause advisories (July 8) · *(the ~8× premium multiple, 39–41% throughput, and P&I-withdrawal figures are from the unofficial straits.live tracker — single-source)* · CoinDesk — BTC \$62,657 under pressure (July 8) · Fortune — BTC ~\$61.7K 21-month low (July 6, pre-escalation) · CoinDesk — ~\$450M liquidations (July 8).
- **The odds (sentiment only, not fact):** Polymarket — Iran markets (invasion before 2027: 14.5%; MoU withdrawal by Aug 15: 26%; final deal by Dec 31: 35.5%) · Blockchain.News — invasion odds 11.5% → 14.5% (secondhand write-up of the Polymarket move).